

AKASH VASHISTA

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Software Development Engineer in Test (SDET) | Test Automation & Build Pipeline Engineer

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

SDET and Automation Engineer with over 6 years of experience engineering automated test frameworks, build pipelines, and software validation solutions. Proven expertise in integrating test suites into GitHub Actions and Jenkins CI/CD pipelines, writing robust test automation in Python, Shell, and TypeScript, and validating distributed and containerized systems under real-world operating conditions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Test Automation & Framework Design: UI & API Test Automation (Playwright, Selenium, Postman, Newman), Framework Architecture & Reusable Automation Components, Regression, Functional & Performance Testing, TestNG, JUnit, Allure Reporting, Cross-Browser & Multi-Platform Testing

Build Pipelines, DevOps & CI/CD: CI/CD Test Integration (GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Azure DevOps), Containerization & Orchestration (Docker, Kubernetes), Fault Tolerance Simulation & Build Automation, Version Control & Code Reviews (Git, GitHub), AWS Cloud Infrastructure Validation

API, Security & Backend Testing: REST & GraphQL API Validation, Database Testing & Verification (PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQL Server), Security Testing (Authentication, Authorization, MFA, SSO), Custom Automation Scripts & Diagnostic Log Analysis

AI & Modern Quality Engineering: AI-Assisted Test Automation, AI Agents & Prompt Workflows (Claude, Antigravity), Automated Workflow Acceleration, Continuous Testing & Defect Detection Optimization

Agile Delivery & Quality Assurance: Test Strategy & Comprehensive Test Plans, Defect Lifecycle Management (Jira, X-Ray, Zephyr), Cross-functional Collaboration (Dev, DevOps, Operations)

PROFESSIONAL STRENGTHS

Scalable Test Automation Frameworks: Proven track record of architecting and building robust UI and API automation frameworks from scratch using Playwright, Selenium, Java, TypeScript, and Postman.

Cloud & Container Resilience: Extensive experience validating AWS cloud services, microservices, and containerized environments on Docker and Kubernetes under simulated failure conditions.

End-to-End API & Security Testing: Deep expertise in validating complex REST and GraphQL APIs, uncovering vulnerabilities in authentication/authorization flows, MFA, SSO, and data exposure.

Agile Leadership & Mentorship: Proactive collaborator in sprint planning and risk assessment, with a strong history of mentoring engineers and driving quality best practices.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Automation Specialist – Plato Nov 2025 - Feb 2026

- Built UI and API automation framework using Playwright integrated with AI agents, reducing test development effort and accelerating regression coverage.
- Designed reusable AI-agent skills and workflows to accelerate test-case creation, automation development, and validation of new application features.
- Mentored junior engineers in automation and AI-driven testing practices.

- Presented project outcomes to the entire company, receiving formal recognition and being featured in the company newsletter for project contributions.

Test Automation Specialist – Plato *Mar 2025 - Jun 2025*

- Integrated CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions and configured Allure reports.
- Led the design of a scalable Selenium-based UI automation framework using Java.
- Automated 10+ end-to-end UI flows and validations, significantly reducing manual QA effort.
- Mentored two QA engineers in UI automation, reviewed pull requests on GitHub, and managed code merges to maintain quality and consistency.

Test Automation Specialist – Employment and Social Development Canada *Jan 2025 - Mar 2025*

- Deployed and managed custom containerized applications using Docker and Kubernetes, validating system reliability by simulating container outages and overload scenarios to ensure fault tolerance and high availability.
- Designed and implemented end-to-end automated tests for dual-interface government applications using TypeScript and Selenium.
- Enhanced the existing UI automation framework by cutting manual testing efforts by 45%.
- Developed automated security test cases for user authentication workflows across multiple platforms, including Service Canada and other provincial service portals.

Software QA Engineer – Imperva *Jun 2021 - Nov 2022*

- Created 8+ custom automation scripts to reduce manual steps and streamline expected results using Shell scripts, APIs and SQL queries.
- Conducted testing of MFA, SSO, and related authentication mechanisms within containerized environments, simulating production-like conditions using Docker on Amazon EC2 infrastructure.
- Built hybrid automation framework using Selenium, Java, and TestNG, increasing automation coverage by 30%.
- Reduced manual API testing by 80% through automation.
- Performed Functional, Exploratory, Regression, Browser Compatibility, GUI testing of an industry-leading Cybersecurity product - Data Security Fabric.

QA Engineer – Nutrien *Jun 2025 - Nov 2025*

- Designed and executed test scenarios to validate business requirements and ensure workflow reliability of mission critical mining applications.
- Automated REST APIs with Postman, reducing manual API validation by 50%.
- Validated backend integrations using AWS services and Postman.
- Performed web and mobile testing (iOS/Android), improving release stability and reducing post-release defects.

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Test Automation: Playwright, Selenium, Postman, Newman, Allure, JUnit, TestNG

Languages: Python, Bash, TypeScript, Java, SQL

API Testing: REST, GraphQL, Postman, Newman, AppSync

Cloud & DevOps: GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQL Server, AWS DocumentDB, AWS Redshift

AI and Automation: AI-Assisted Test Automation, AI Agents, Claude, Antigravity

Tools & Collaboration: Jira, X-Ray, Zephyr, GitHub, VS Code, Figma, PowerShell

EDUCATION

Master of Science - Computer Science – Western University (Dec 2020)

Bachelor of Technology – M.S. Institute of Technology (Jun 2018)